

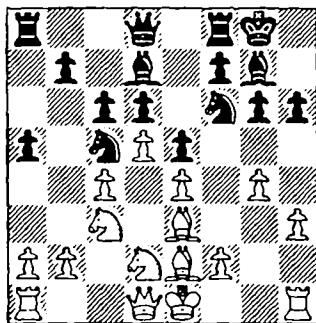


Diagram 12

Black prepares queenside play

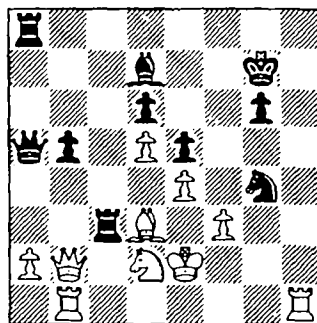


Diagram 13

Black attacks on both flanks

The plan is to play ...a5-a4 and ...Qa5 to develop an initiative.

13 h4 a4 14 h5

It is not such a good idea for White to ignore the threat of ...Qa5. However, even after 14 g5 hxg5 15 hxg5 Nh7 16 Nf3 cxd5 17 cxd5 Qa5 18 Qd2 Rf8 19 Kf1 b5 Black had active play in Akesson-Gallagher, Istanbul Olympiad 2000.

14...Qa5 15 f3 a3!

And this was the other threat. Ideally, White would like to meet this move with 16 b3 but this just loses the knight on c3. By exchanging his a-pawn for White's b-pawn Black gains a positional advantage.

16 Qc2 axb2 17 Qxb2 cxd5 18 cxd5 b5! 19 Rb1

The pawn could not be taken. 19 Nxb5 Rf8 20 a4 Bxb5! and now 21 axb5 loses a rook and 21 Bxb5 Nd3+, a queen

19...Rf8

It's not unusual for Black to sacrifice the h6-pawn in the King's Indian. In return he hopes to take control of the dark squares.

20 hxg6 fxg6 21 Bxh6 Nd3+! 22 Bxd3 Rxc3 23 Bxg7 Kxg7 24 Ke2
24 Be2 Rac8 was better but Black has more than enough for the pawn.

24...Nxg4! (Diagram 13) 25 Qb4

After 25 fxg4 Bxg4+ the only move not to lose the piece back at once is 26 Ke3 but then 26...Qb6! is mate.

25...Rxd3! 26 fxg4

26 Qxa5 Re3+! 27 Kf1 Rxa5 28 fxg4 Rxa2 is an even worse endgame.

26...Qxb4 27 Rxb4 Rg3 28 Rb2 Rf8 29 Kd1 Bxg4+ 30 Kc1 Rc8+ 31 Kb1 Be2 32 Re1 Bd3+ 33 Ka1 Rg2 34 Nb3 Rxb2 35 Kxb2 Rc4
White resigns

White loses a second pawn. An excellent game from Black.

Game 63

□ Kavalek ■ Kasparov

Bugojno 1982

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Nf3 0-0 6 h3 e5 7 d5 Na6 8 Be3

This time White doesn't bother to try and tempt ...h7-h6 out of Black but develops his bishop directly to e3.

8...Nh5

Black prepares ...f7-f5 in the most active fashion. This is the line that has put most White players off playing 8 Be3. The line with ...Nh5 is less good with a pawn on h6 (8 Bg5 h6 9 Be3 Nh5) as at some point White can gain an important tempo with Qd2.

The plan that Black used in Game 62 is also playable here. After 8...Nc5 9 Nd2 a5 10 g4 c6 11 Be2, the position is the same (as in Game 62) except for the fact that Black has a pawn on h7 instead of h6. This seemingly insignificant difference is enough to make the way Black played in the previous game unattractive (11...Bd7 12 g5!), but at the same time introduces a new possibility that wasn't really available to Black there. After 11 Be2, the Russian Grandmaster Dolmatov has patented the pawn sacrifice 11...a4!. The point is that White has to give up his important dark-squared bishop to win the pawn. Few grandmasters would take White after 12 Bxc5 dxc5 13 Nxa4 Qa5 14 Nc3 Bh6! (note this last move wouldn't have been available with a pawn on h6). If White doesn't take the pawn Black plays ...Qa5 with pressure on the queenside.

9 Nh2

This strange-looking move prevents the immediate 9...f5 as after 10 exf5 Black can no longer recapture with the pawn. That explains the thinking behind Black's next move.

9...Qe8 10 Be2 Nf4

10...f5 is a major alternative which Kasparov has also played. Black's main idea is to meet 11 exf5 with 11...Nf4 when White should settle for the roughly level position that arises after 12 0-0 Bxf5 rather than risk 12 Bxf4 exf4 13 fxg6 Qxg6 14 Kf1 Nc5 when Black has excellent compensation for the pawn.

11 Bf3 f5 12 h4?!

White's ambitious strategy is based on playing g3 to expel the knight (12 g3 Nxh3 is good for Black) but this is too risky with his king still in the centre. He should have played 12 0-0 with a roughly level game after 12...Nc5.

12...Qe7 13 g3 Nb4! (Diagram 14) 14 Qb3?

Kavalek had no doubt been shocked by Black's previous move but it is suicidal to keep his king in the centre. He had to play 14 0-0 against which Kasparov intended 14...g5!. The white king is certainly not out

of the woods yet. Taking the knight would have been too dangerous with the white king in the centre.

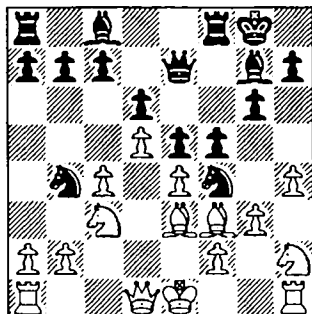


Diagram 14

Kasparov ignores his opponent's threat

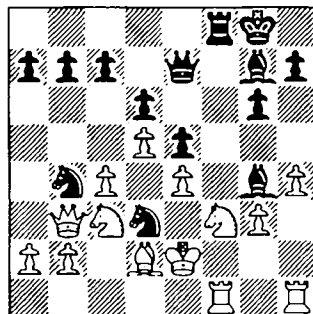


Diagram 15

How should White defend?

14...Nfd3+! 15 Ke2 f4 16 Bd2 fxg3?

Kasparov gives 16 ...Nxf2! 17 Kxf2 Nd3+ 18 Kg2 (18 Ke2 Nc5 followed by ...fxg3) 18...fxg3 19 Kxg3 and now the further sacrifice 19 ..Rf4! with a decisive attack.

17 fxg3 Rxf3! 18 Nxf3 Bg4 19 Raf1 Rf8 (Diagram 15)

Black now threatens 20...Rxf3 21 Rxf3 Bxf3+ 22 Kxf3+ Qf6+ followed by an invasion on f2. To meet this White must defend the f2-square

20 Nd1?

Kavalek does it the wrong way. He should have played 20 Be3! as this also gives his king a new square on d2. According to Kasparov this leads to a draw after the decoy sacrifice 20...Bh6!.

20...Qf7! 21 Be3 Bxf3+ 22 Kd2 Qd7 23 Rhg1 Qh3 24 a3 Bxe4 25 Rxf8+ Bxf8 26 axb4 Qh2+ 27 Kc3 Nc1 White resigns

Summary

- 1) The systems with h2-h3 usually lead to a rich full-blooded struggle where Black must play actively to avoid been squashed.
- 2) The idea of a2-a3 and b2-b4 is an important stratagem for White to lock the knight on a6 out of the game. Unless Black has made gains in other parts of the board he will be in trouble if this happens
- 3) In the lines where Black plays ...f7-f5 White must keep control of the e4-square. If he fails to do so Black may be able to advance his e-pawn with devastating effect.
- 4) White scores much better when he plays with Bg5 rather than with Be3. In fact, it has become quite unusual for White not to play Bg5.

Chapter Ten

Other Systems



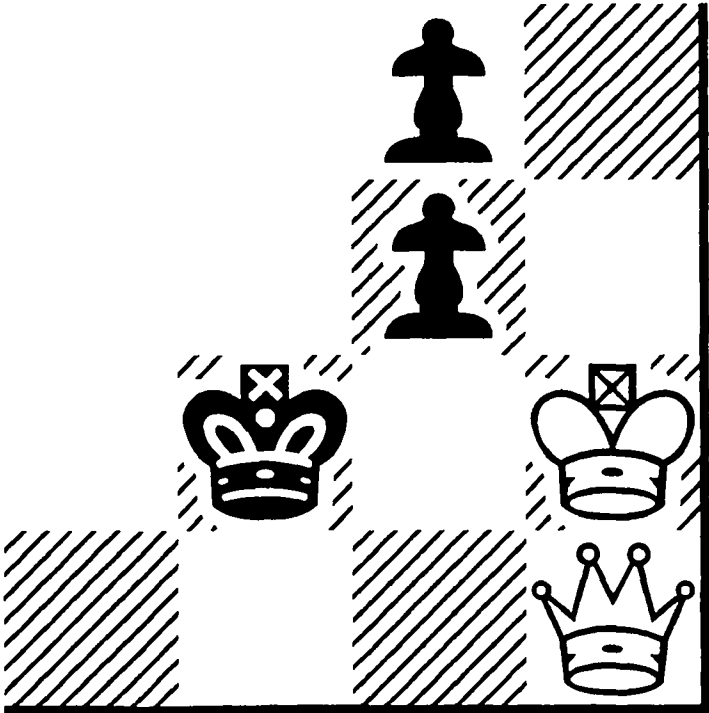
5 Bd3



5 Nge2



The Smyslov Variation



This chapter contains three other variations in the King's Indian that occur from time to time. They are not necessarily worse than any of the other lines, just less fashionable.

5 Bd3

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Bd3 (Diagram 1)

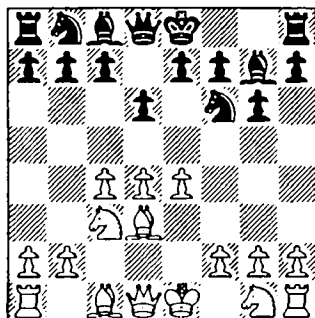


Diagram 1
Seirawan's favourite

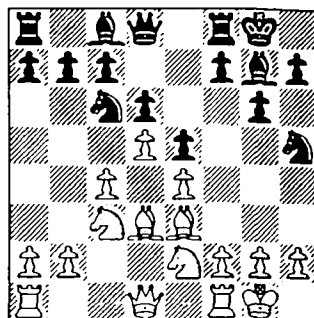


Diagram 2
Retreat or advance?

Some strong grandmasters play this system quite regularly and its main supporter over the years has been the former American Champion Yasser Seirawan.

Strategy

White has a simple plan. He will develop his kingside quickly with Bd3, Nge2 and 0-0 and be ready to meet any subsequent ...f7-f5 by Black with exf5 and f2-f4. This is a solid line in which Black's chances of a successful kingside attack are slim. The main drawback to an early Bd3 is that it slackens White's already rather shaky grip on d4. Therefore, it is no great surprise that Black's most popular defence is based on a quick assault against this point.

5...0-0 6 Nge2 Nc6

After 6...c5 7 d5 Black has to be ready to play a well known line in the Modern Benoni so that is beyond the scope of this book.

6. ...e5 is played surprisingly rarely. One example is Conquest-Hernandez, Havana 1996, which continued 7 d5 Nh5 8 0-0 f5 9 exf5 Bxf5!? 10 Bxf5 gxf5 11 f4 (11 Ng3 is interesting – see Game 64 for a similar idea) 11...Nd7 12 Qc2 a6 with chances for both sides.

7 0-0 Nh5!?

A most unusual move for the King's Indian. Black hardly ever moves this knight before playing ...e7-e5. This position has now become the

main battleground in the 5 Bd3 variation mainly because of dissatisfaction with the alternatives. Black used to play 7...e5 quite often but a number of games established that after 8 d5 Nd4 9 Nxd4 exd4 10 Nb5 Re8 11 Re1 Ng4 12 h3 a6 13 hxg4 axb5 14 cxb5 Qh4 both 15 Bf4 and 15 g3 give White a clear edge. He has a guaranteed passed pawn on the a-file and some pressure down the half open c-file.

8 Be3

This is the obvious way to defend d4 but White has two alternatives:

1) The obvious-looking 8 d5 has hardly ever been played. After 8...Ne5 9 f4 Nxd3 10 Qxd3 f5!? the situation is very double-edged.

2) 8 Bc2, currently White's most popular move, is covered in Game 64.

8...e5 9 d5 (Diagram 2) 9...Ne7!? 9...Nd4 looks more natural.

1) If White now plays 10 Rc1 Black has the time to play 10...c5 11 dxc6 bxc6 12 b4 c5! which secures the fine outpost on d4 for his knight. Admittedly, White now has d5 for his knight but you can't have everything in life.

2) 10 Bc2!? forces Black to exchange his knight. After 10...Nxc2 11 Qxc2 f5 12 exf5 gxf5 13 f4 Nf6 14 h3 White probably has a slight advantage.

10 Qd2 f5 11 exf5 gxf5 12 f4

12 Bg5 f4! led to a most complicated game in Christiansen-Gallagher, Bern 1996.

12...Ng6! 13 g3 Bd7 14 Rae1 a6 15 b3

The chances are about equal.

Theoretical?

Most of the lines in this chapter are played to avoid the masses of theory in other variations. Black players are also likely to be less familiar with them so can easily get in trouble. 5 Bd3 is an easy line to play for White if he just wants to get out of the opening with a reasonable position.

Statistics

White has scored 56% with 5 Bd3 from nearly 1900 games. In our main line with 7...Nh5, his score is about the same.

Illustrative Games

Game 64

☐ Piket ☒ Fedorov

Wijk aan Zee 2001

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Bd3 0-0 6 Nge2 Nc6 7 0-0